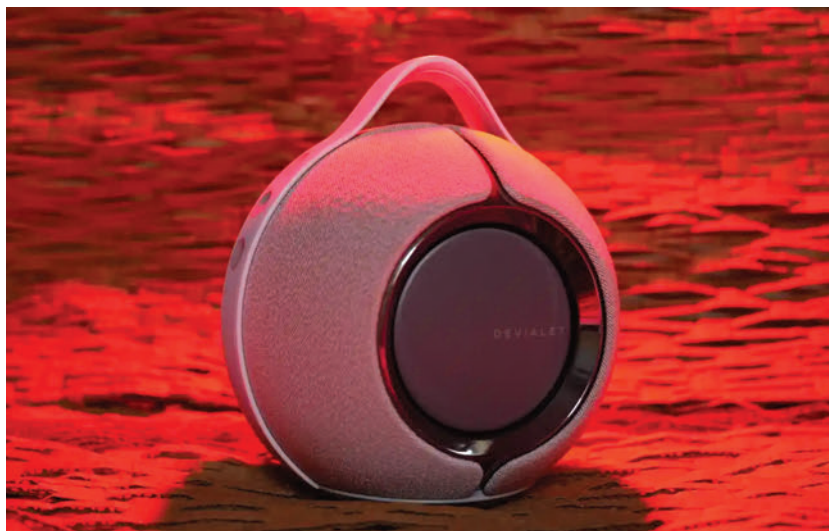




can also activate Amazon Alexa directly from the speaker itself. It does well in this department as well, picking up commands almost seamlessly.

Now, lastly, let's talk about ASC - Active Stereo Calibration. This is basically an environment mapping feature that adapts the sound of the speaker based on its surroundings. I did not notice much of a difference in our studio, where I primarily test speakers, but in a more cluttered environment, the speaker did adapt to match the sound that it delivered in ideal conditions. To add to the list of quality of life features, lastly, there is support for wireless charging with the Devialet Mania Station, which is an added accessory that you can buy.

As I prefaced earlier, the speaker does not come loaded with features, like many other offerings in the premium speakers market. However, the ones that are there, are solid. You must have seen in the scores that it got 5.1/10. There are other speakers from the likes of JBL, for example, their Boombox 3 Wi-Fi, which won our Best Buy Award in the Bluetooth speakers category in 2023, that will bring to the table, all the features that you could ask for. So, if number of features is likely to define your purchase decision, you should look elsewhere.

PERFORMANCE

Devialet Mania makes up all the ground

that it lost in the features department, over here. The Mania excelled in producing the lower bass frequencies. However, when it came to treble, I noticed a lack of some details, which cost it some points in our tests. The competition remained intense, with the Mania delivering some of the finest vocals I've experienced on a Bluetooth speaker. This was also true for other instruments, and the speaker's distortion, or rather the absence of it.

The frequency response of the speaker is consistent, and across genres of music, you will have no complaints in how it sounds. Although, it will favour bassier tracks over the ones that have a lot of elements in the treble. The soundstage of the speaker, especially for its size, is massive. The dual driver setup, lends itself to great use in producing a 360 degree experience when you are using it.

The area where the Mania lost significant ground is its loudness. While it does get fairly loud, it is not enough for large rooms. This is not going to be your primary party speaker if you are looking for one. If I were to borrow a metaphor from the world of cars, this speaker is like a Rolls Royce. It can go fast, but you will not be able to take it to your next track day. You will be better off loaning a Porsche, which in this case, would be a part speaker from the likes of LG, Sony, or JBL. The Devialet Mania is a luxury

speaker, meant for giving an exquisite listening experience for you, in your personal space.

BATTERY LIFE

In terms of the battery life, Devialet Claims that you can get up to 10 hours of playtime. In our tests, the speaker clocked in at around 4 hours and 35 minutes. There is a sizeable difference between the claimed numbers and the actual performance. If you do run out of juice, you can power it directly via USB-C, while also juicing it up. The wireless charging capability is there, however, only if you are willing to shell out extra money for the Devialet Mania Station. It would be nice to have a more universal charging standard on the speaker.

VERDICT

The bottomline with the Devialet Mania is that it is a product that you will have not regrets buying, if you have your eyes set on it, and expectations weighed properly, and deep enough pockets. It sounds great, matches up to its price tag with its design, and nails all the features that you get, albeit them being the basics that will get the job done. There are others like the Marshall Woburn III at ₹59,999, which for the price will get you a great experience as well. If you are looking for a party speaker or the most value for money, you can look at offerings like the Sony MHC-V83D or the JBL Boombox 3 Wi-Fi, which are substantially cheaper than the Mania, and have a ton of features packed in them, while delivering loud and mostly pleasing sound.

—Satvik Pandey

SPECIFICATIONS

Loudspeakers 4 Aluminium full-range drivers + 2 woofers | Processor 4 x ARM Cortex-A53 1.4Ghz processor | Power Supply 3200mAh in-built battery USB-C PD 12V 2.5A | Power Consumption: <2W (in standby) <0.5W (in off mode) | Maximum Sound Level 95 dB SPL at 1 meter | Total amplification power 2x38W class-D for woofers, 4x25W class-D for full-range speakers | Frequency response (bandwidth) 30Hz - 20kHz | Dimension 176 mm x 193 mm x 139 mm | Weight 2.3 kg